

An Empirical Study on the Effect of Organizational Citizenship Behavior on Subjective Well-being and Job Performance

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Abstract— Generally speaking, the organizational citizenship behavior (OCB) of employees and the degree of organizational socialization play significant roles in job performance and employees' feelings. In this research, an empirical tracking study was conducted. First, two OCB dimensions were measured on campus. Second, four organizational socialization dimensions were measured in the workplace. Five months later, subjective well-being and job performance were measured in the workplace as well. Thereafter, the effect of the OCB on subjective well-being and job performance was analyzed, regarding the organizational socialization as an intermediate variable. Based on the 86 samples, the following conclusions were reached: (1) the OCB of undergraduates on campus has a positive effect on their subjective well-being and job performance in the workplace, (2) organizational Socialization has a fully mediating effect on the relationship between OCB and subjective well-being, and (3) organizational Socialization has a partially mediating effect on the relationship between OCB and job performance.

Keywords—organizational citizenship behavior (OCB); subjective well-being; job performance; organizational socialization; organizational boundary

I. INTRODUCTION

With the development of economic globalization, enterprises are facing increasingly fierce competition. Peter Drucker, the great master of modern administration, thinks that the most basic resource is talent rather than capital, natural resources or labor force any more. Human resources have become the core competition among enterprises. Accordingly, how to manage and make use of human resources has become one of the most important problems lately. Organizational Citizenship Behavior (OCB for short below) is one of the core issues. Organ defines OCB as a kind of behavior that is discretionary, not directly or explicitly recognized by formal reward system, and that in the aggregate promotes the effective functioning of organization [1]. Since the concept of OCB has been proposed, the studies of OCB in our country and outside have focused on the dimension of OCB, antecedent variables, outcome variables and the measurement of variables [2]. Furthermore, the studies on OCB of inter-organizations are few. OCB is chosen as an independent variable for further exploration of influences of OCB on employees' subjective well-being and job performance.

Subjective well-being has been one of the most popular words in China recently, but the academic findings show the decline of happiness in many kinds of occupations, like teachers, office workers and so on. Some researchers point out

that with this trend, the decline of happiness would influence the job performance. Correspondingly, more and more enterprises begin to pay more attention to the promotion of employees' job satisfaction and subjective well-being, as well as job performance. The purposes of our study that focuses on the subjective well-being are as follows: (1) give birth to more attention to subjective well-being in enterprises, furthermore encourage more companies to pay attention to the psychological counseling of employees, (2) identify the positive or negative effects of subjective well-being on employees, and (3) study the impact factors of subjective well-being, and provide the evidence of increasing subjective well-being of employees. According to our general survey of existing studies, there are three questions that need to be solved: (1) the existence of influence of OCB on subjective well-being and job performance, (2) the influence mechanism of OCB on subjective well-being and job performance, and (3) the kind of influence mechanism of OCB to subjective well-being and job performance. The study and discussion of all the questions above not only help to find the relationship and mechanism of variables, but also provide suggestions for HRM's recruitment, selection and training. Finally, we are looking forward to improve the performance of employees with the increasing of subjective well-being.

II. LITERATURE REVIEW

A. OCB of Undergraduates

From the historical root of OCB (organizational citizenship behavior), this concept was first proposed in 1983[3]. On the base of former studies, Organ proposed the concept of OCB formally [4]: individuals put it up spontaneously, and this behavior is not clearly or directly verified in organization's formal compensation system, but as a whole, this individual behavior benefits the performance of organization. For the dimensions of OCB, many researchers have proposed their own ideas. Among them there are two-dimensional structure, three-dimensional structure, four-dimensional structure, five-dimensional structure, nine-dimensional structure and so on [5-9]. To sum up, main characteristic dimensions are proposed as followings: Altruism, Generalized Compliance, Courtesy, Cheerleading, Peacekeeping, Sportsmanship, Civic Virtue, Conscientiousness and so on. In a word, OCB is a multidimensional construct that cannot be explained by a single factor. At the same time, it should be noticed that there are some differences among constructions of measurement criteria of different group's OCB. For instance, the OCB of undergraduates in college are different from employees in the

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workplace. Having classifying all the research findings above, as for our study, Zou's definition of OCB for undergraduates in "An empirical experiment on the sense of organizational fairness on OCB of undergraduates" [10] were used: They are some spontaneous behaviors which are not fixed by colleges clearly and definitely. These behaviors not only include positive behaviors like being eager to help others, defending organizations and participating in public welfare, but also include unwillingness for negative behaviors through self-control.

B. OCB of Undergraduates on Campus, Subjective Well-being and Job Performance

Subjective well-being, which includes life satisfaction, experiences of positive emotion and negative emotion, is a comprehensive psychological indicator of life quality. Characteristics of subjective well-being are subjectivity, integrity and stability [11]. Job performance is a collection of some observable behaviors performed by employees to achieve the purpose of an organization [12], including task performance and contextual performance. According to the social learning theory, people tend to imitate behaviors that are strengthened by others; OCB of undergraduates on campus, which is constantly strengthened when living on friendly relationship with people, will get further development and have an effect on their job performance and subjective well-being as well. Findings published by Parsons, CK, Caylor, E and Simmons, HS show that proactive behavior by students has a significant effect on both learning outcomes and well-being [13]. According to the social exchange theory, all human social activities boil down to a kind of exchange. Therefore, when OCB is considered to be useful for the organization as a fair exchange, employees with OCB are cared trusted and supported. Employees' job performance and happiness get improved by all the factors above. Therefore:

H1: Subjective well-being and job performance are related to OCB of undergraduates.

H1a: There are significant positive effects of OCB of undergraduates on subjective well-being.

H1b: There are significant positive effects of OCB of undergraduates on job performance.

C. OCB, Organizational Socialization, Subjective Well-being and Job Performance

Organizational socialization promotes the resource-sharing among employees, advancing work ability. Organizational socialization is considered to be related to job performance. Allen found that employees could adjust their value, attitude and behavior to fit into the workplace with the guidance of organizational socialization [14]. More importantly, Cooper and Anderson have found that organizational socialization promotes job performance of employees [15]. Among some prior studies, organizational socialization is proved to have a significant effect on increase of job satisfaction which is highly related with subjective well-being [16-19]. Therefore:

H2: Organizational socialization is a mediating variable in the relationship between OCB and subjective well-being.

H3: Organizational socialization is a mediating variable in

the relationship between OCB and job performance.

III. METHODS

A. Participants

Undergraduates are tracked for nine months in this research. Questionnaires are sent by three times: in the senior year, three months after working, five months after working. Through alumni directory and campus BBS, seniors going to work as goal samples are found. Questionnaires about Undergraduates OCB are sent on May, 2013, 300 in total. The effective recovery is 66% (N1=198). Questionnaires about Undergraduates Organizational Socialization are sent to those 198 students, the effective recovery is 76.7% (N2=152). Finally, Questionnaires about Undergraduates Subjective Well-being and Work Performance are sent to the former participants, the effective rate of recovery is 54.4% (N3=86). Questionnaires are distributed in Beijing, Xi'an, Guangzhou and Shanghai. After the final integration, the male of the final data analysis of 86 samples is 40.7%, and the female is 59.3%. The city citizens account for 63.3%, and the country citizens account for 36.7%.

B. Measures

1) OCB of Undergraduates

There are many questionnaires about teachers and staffs' OCB domestic and overseas. However, questionnaires about undergraduates are fewer. The representative of them is The OCB Questionnaire, which is organized by Zou Wei [20]. The reliability coefficient of internal consistency of this questionnaire is 0.9041. Generally speaking, the reliability demand of statistics is over 0.700, which means the result is reliable.

2) Subjective Well-being

The concise inventory is adopted: Chinese Happiness Inventory (CHI for short), which is organized by Lu Lou and Shi Jianbin [21]. There are 10 questions, and the total is a whole dimension. The reliability coefficient of internal consistency (Cronbach's Alpha) is 0.9428 and the half reliability is 0.9310, thus the consistency of questions is very high. And the KMO value is 0.955, the approximate chi-square value of the spherical test is 15764.408 (degree of freedom is 1128), thus the validity of this is rather high.

3) Job Performance

Barman's two-dimension [12] is widely used and approved in the relevant researches, dividing the job performance into task performance and contextual performance. The reliability of the questionnaire is 0.873 and the KMO value is 0.812, which is higher than 0.7.

4) Organization Socialization

We choose the Undergraduates Organizational Socialization Questionnaire, whose reliability coefficient of internal consistency is 0.833. The final explain variance rate is 55.998%, which accords with the demand of psychometric.

C. The Questionnaire Validity Check

As we can see from Table I, five questionnaires that the research chooses show a fine reliability. The reliability coefficient of OCB of undergraduates, subjective well-being,

job performance and organizational socialization are all higher than 0.80.

TABLE I. Cronbach's Alpha Value of Different Variables

Variables Name	Cronbach's Alpha Value	Number of Terms
OCB of Undergraduates	0.900	17
Subjective Well-being	0.898	10
Job Performance	0.868	21
Organizational Socialization	0.837	15

IV. RESULTS

A. Descriptive statistics and Correlation Analysis of Variables

We regard gender, major and region of undergraduates as control variables. The measuring tools are: a 5-point scale measuring OCB, a 4-point scale measuring subjective well-being, a 6-point scale measuring job performance and a 6-point scale measuring organizational socialization. Table II displays the mean values of variables and standard deviations of all variables are not abnormal. The OCB of undergraduates, subjective well-being, job performance and organizational socialization are basically significant correlation at the level of 0.01. And results preliminarily indicate the direct hypothesis relationship among them.

TABLE II. Descriptive Statistics and Pearson Correlation Coefficient of Variables (N=86)

Variable Name	Mean Value	Standard Deviation	The OCB of Undergraduates	Subjective Well-being	Job Performance	Organizational Socialization
1	4.5065	0.68082				
2	4.7994	0.72337	0.0286**			
3	2.5556	0.52643	0.433**	0.333**		
4	4.8295	0.55984	0.419**	0.392**	0.739**	
5	4.4842	0.53266	0.124	0.197	0.352**	0.288**

a.** Significantly correlated at the 0.01 level (bilateral)

B. The Mediating Effect on the Relationship between OCB and Job Performance (Subjective Well-being)

According to Baron and Kenny [22], the preconditions of using the regression model to test the mediation effect are: (1) there is a significant correlation with independent variable and dependent variable, as well as intermediary variable and dependent variable, (2) there is a significant correlation with independent variable and intermediary variable, and (3) the correlation between independent variable and dependent variable will be weakened after the involvement of the intermediary variable in the regression model, while the correlation between intermediary variable and dependent variable is still significant. All variance inflation factors (VIF) in model 1 to 6 are far less than the critical value of 10, indicating that there is no serious collinearity and the results of the models are acceptable.

As shown in Table III, Model 2 shows that OCB is positively correlated with subjective well-being, with the

regression coefficient of 0.264 ($p < 0.05$). Thus, hypothesis H1a is supported. Model 3 shows the regression coefficient between OCB and subjective well-being is 0.100 ($p > 0.05$), furthermore the regression coefficient between organizational socialization and subjective well-being is 0.325 ($p < 0.05$), after inviting organizational socialization as an intervening variable. Therefore, organizational socialization has a fully mediating effect on the relationship between OCB and subjective well-being. Hypothesis H2a is supported.

As shown in Table III, Model 5 shows the OCB is positively correlated with job performance, with the regression coefficient of 0.367 ($p < 0.05$). Therefore, hypothesis H1b is supported. Model 6 shows the regression coefficient between organizational citizenship behavior and job performance is 0.127 ($p < 0.05$), the regression coefficient between organizational socialization and job performance is 0.766 ($p < 0.01$), after inviting organizational socialization as an intervening variable. Therefore, organizational socialization has a partially mediating effect on the relationship between OCB and job performance. Hypothesis H2b is supported.

TABLE III. Mediating Effect of the Relationship between OCB and Job Performance (Subjective Well-being)

Variables	Dependent Variable: Subjective Well-being			Dependent Variable: Job Performance		
	Model 1	Model 2	Model 3	Model 4	Model 5	Model 6
Constant	2.427	1.546	0.414	4.749	3.147	0.484
Control Variables						
Sex	.054	.061	0.112	0.084	.096	0.217
Major	0.135	.099	0.077	0.001	-0.064	-0.115
Region	-0.121	-0.109	-0.049	-.040	-0.017	0.122
OCB		0.202**	0.100		0.367**	0.127*
Organizational Socialization			0.325**			0.766**

b.* $p < 0.05$; ** $p < 0.01$

We conduct the research which crosses organization boundaries with the focus on undergraduates. The study indicates that OCB of undergraduates has a positive effect on their performance among this group of participants. And the correlation coefficient between OCB and subjective well-being and job performance is slightly inferior to which of employees' of the same boundary [23-25]. The final results prove that the OCB of undergraduates has a positive effect on other people or their organizations. Results show that undergraduates with high level of OCB are able to adapt to the formal and informal rules in company more quickly. Furthermore with the ability to adjust their own attitudes and behaviors, undergraduates can blend into the environment better, increase the social capital quickly, finish tasks effectively and be in a happy mood usually.

C. The Mediating Effect of Organization Socialization on the Relationship between OCB of Undergraduates, Subjective Well-being and Job Performance

The study shows that organization socialization has a

mediating effect on the relationship between OCB and job performance to some extent. It also indicates a fully mediating effect on the relationship between OCB and subjective well-being. OCB of undergraduates is one of the altruistic behaviors and organization socialization is a kind of work-adapting behavior. After undergraduates entering companies, the ones with higher level of OCB will adapt to work better, and develop a harmonious interpersonal relationship. Besides, undergraduates tend to do other things which avail organizations but are out of their own working scope. Accordingly, OCB influences the organization socialization, which can influence subjective well-being and job performance as well. The OCB can increase the job performance directly rather than through the intervening mechanism of organization socialization. Although the subjective well-being has an effect on salary, welfare, staff training, self-achievement and so on [26], depending on social support and self-efficacy more [27]. In conclusion, OCB of undergraduates increases subjective well-being through the improvement of employees' organization socialization.

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